Superior Huntingdon COMPOSITES, LLC

5-WHY ROOT CAUSE WORKSHEET

Superior Huntingdon Composites | EHS-IR-002

Incident Ref: _____ Site: [ ]Vanceburg [ ]Huntingdon Investigator: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Do NOT start with blame. Start with the fact of what happened, then keep asking 'WHY' to move from the obvious toward the deepest cause you can actually fix. Stop when the answer points to a training, design, process, equipment, supervision, or culture gap that a corrective action can target.

STEP 1 - START WITH THE FACT

What HAPPENED? (the fact - what did the person/equipment actually do? No interpretation yet)

STEP 2 - ASK WHY 5 TIMES, GOING DEEPER

Each Why answers the one ABOVE it. Resist stopping at 'the worker made a mistake' - that is usually a symptom, not a cause. Push toward the SYSTEM that allowed it.

WHY 1 - Why did this happen? - GO DEEPER: What was the immediate action or condition that produced the incident?

WHY 2 - Why did that happen? - GO DEEPER: What caused that action or condition - was the person trained? was the process clear?

WHY 3 - Why did that happen? - GO DEEPER: Why wasn't a guard, procedure, training, or control in place?

WHY 4 - Why did that happen? - GO DEEPER: Was there a gap in the SYSTEM - equipment design, supervision, ergonomics, rotation?

WHY 5 - ROOT CAUSE - Why did that happen? - STOP HERE: This is the deepest cause you can ACT ON and FIX.

STEP 3 - THE ROOT CAUSE, STATED CLEANLY

Root Cause (one sentence, names the system gap - NOT the worker's mistake):

STEP 4 - CORRECTIVE ACTION(S)

One action per line. Each must have an OWNER, a DUE DATE, and a VERIFY step. For parallel causes, list multiple actions.

Action 1: _____ Owner: _____ Due: _____ Verify: [ ]

Action 2: _____ Owner: _____ Due: _____ Verify: [ ]

Action 3: _____ Owner: _____ Due: _____ Verify: [ ]

STEP 5 - CHECK & LEARN

Did the Root Cause pass the 'fix test'? [ ] Yes - a corrective action can address it [ ] No - keep digging lower. Is the Root Cause a SYSTEM gap (training, design, process, culture, equipment, supervision) rather than an individual blunder? [ ] Yes [ ] No.

REMEMBER: If the answer to any WHY is 'the worker should have known better' - keep going. Ask 'why didn't the system make it easy for them to do it right?' That is where real prevention lives.